

Welcome to Maratua Island!

As employees of Anggrek Bulan Nusantara, it's that time of year to embark on a week-long work trip to Maratua Paradise Resort to build rapport amongst each other and heighten a sense of unity... Or that is the proposed trip in order to gain funding from Melati, at least.

In truth, this 'employee perk' gives time for agents to relax and mentally recuperate after what horrors they encounter on the job. No actual group activities are present, unless the agents incite them themselves. Though the trip and its small fee is mandatory for employees, Bulan allows each employee to optionally pay for an additional person should they wish, in an attempt to let agents focus on their personal relationships.

Covered facilities include 3 meals a day (breakfast, lunch, dinner), wifi, and access to the following for the week:

Fulfil responsibilities: spend time with your +1

Back to nature: spend time alone in this nature-integrated resort

Establish a new bond: with your +1

Improve skills/stats/special training:

- **Athletics/STR/DEX**: trekking, swimming, snorkeling, free diving, kayaking, spearfishing, archery
- **Swim**: swimming in the pool/sea, snorkeling, free diving
- **Navigate**: observing open waters and landmarks while trekking
- **Relevant Science/INT**: learn about the wildlife, environment, botany, etc on land/water
- **CON**: build stamina via trekking, swimming
- **Small boat (Pilot)**: observe how boats are driven as you ride them

Special training:

- **SCUBA gear (Swim)**: taking an intro course to scuba diving

Indulge in personal motivation: if it makes sense for the Agent

When the Week Ends...

On the fifth night (22 June), the 5-year-old son of a couple vanishes. The following morning on the sixth day (23 June), staff members search through the resort and its adjacent beach. The island is far too large to search through at the moment.

The staff will also ask Agents if they've seen any sign of the boy. **Any checks made are inconclusive**: there are no traces of the boy, as if he truly vanished into thin air. However, they may notice that the water have become considerably rockier and that the grey sky indicates an incoming storm.

At night, a staff member's scream awakens all the members of the resort. If any one of them goes out to check on the commotion, they will see the boy's father, bloodied and dead.

The Truth

About a year ago, a Kuntilanak was found on the beach adjacent to the resort by **Gilang**, the gardener. He tells the new general manager **Ari** and together, the two hunt the Kuntilanak down. Gilang does most of the fighting, resulting in his scars. Ari drives a nail into the Kuntilanak's throat, suddenly subduing her and transforming her into a beautiful pregnant woman. Not knowing what to do with a pregnant woman suddenly appearing on a beach while also taking advantage of the folklore, Ari names the kuntilanak **Ida** and takes her as his wife.

In current time, **Irfan and Yanti** arrive at the resort with their son **Devin**. Irfan believes in the Unnatural and is responsible for three things:

1. **The disappearance of his son.** As Mamesah has gone dark, Irfan decided to take his son's transaction in his own hands. Given the resort's isolated location, Irfan deemed it a fitting place to sacrifice Devin as a test subject to a K'nyani in exchange for forbidden knowledge. However, Devin was inadequate. Irfan was desperate for another sacrifice.
2. **His death.** The next day, Irfan targets Ida to forcefully abort her child to give to the K'ny'ni. This doesn't work as Ida isn't actually pregnant. In panic, Irfan strangles her, finds the nail in her neck, and pulls it out, hoping she will suffocate. Ida instead transforms into her true form and murders him. Ida is able to transform back into her female form, still pregnant, but her hypergeometry and false loyalty to Ari are released.
3. **The eternal storm.** In Irfan's possession is a hypergeometric relic. It is an crystalline rock which, on closer inspection, looks like one half of a larger rock. Both halves make up an orb that powers the sceptre of Nyi Roro Kidul that were lost many years ago. On her quest to recover her orb, she had followed its power beyond her domain of the Indian Ocean to Maratua, trapping the resort in a storm until she's returned her orb, or until her patience runs out and she destroys the resort.

Nyi Roro Kidul's storm prevents anyone from leaving the resort and interferes with communication devices. The Agents are effectively isolated on this island with no communication to the rest of the world. This means they have no access to additional gear, equipment, and weapons outside what they brought. There is, however, enough sustenance to last a month.

The storm will worsen over one week until Nyi Roro Kidul's storm destroys everything. Her hypergeometry has also caused the moon to be permanently a full moon only within the resort's region. This not only aids with her control of the waves, but also allows Ida's Kuntilanak form to emerge anytime at night.

A Cold Night, a Cold Body

 *Rusty Lake Theme - Cube Escape: Birthday*

Location: Maratua Paradise Resort, Pulau Maratua, Kalimantan Timur

Date: Friday, 24 June 2011, 12am

Irfan's body is found away from the rooms, on a platform closer to the beach. The large pool of blood he lies in is beginning to thicken and crust onto his pale, ravaged skin. Looking at his gored body costs **SAN 0/1 Violence**. His stomach cavity has been torn into, his ribcage has been pried open,

and his throat has been hollowed out, from which his internal organs are missing. All that's left are skin, bones, arteries, and his head. Agents with the appropriate skills can observe the following:

- **FORENSICS:** the body is fresh and could not be older than 5 hours. There are traces of sand and small rocks in his sandals and under his toenails and fingernails. There is also blood under his fingernails, which may hint at a struggle. With a microscope, typical mammalian epidermal cells can also be found under his fingernails, with some evidence of hair follicles.
- **FORENSICS or SURVIVAL:** the deep lacerations around his body were made by something long, sharp, and thin. It looks as if he was mauled by a four or five-toed animal. His vocal chords have been slashed through.
- **FORENSICS 40% or SURGERY:** through hastily torn and ruptured arteries, that his organs were not cleanly removed from his body.
- **FORENSICS 60% or SURGERY:** rather than Irfan's body being bitten or cut into, Irfan's body was torn open in two opposite directions, like opening a box with both hands.

Timeline

22 June, night	Irfan sacrifices Devin to a K'nyini. The K'nyini leaves without giving anything in return. Ida witnesses this due to detecting the K'nyini's presence and knows what Irfan did was wrong.
23 June, morning	The resort looks for Devin. Bagas steals Irfan's rock. Ani catches him holding it and immediately figures it does not belong to him. She tells Gabriel to talk to Bagas.
9:30pm	Bagas is about to head to his quarters. Gabriel pulls him into the kitchen and the two argue.
10:00pm	Gabriel storms off to Bagas' room, threatening Bagas to throw the rock away, as Gilang arrives in the kitchen to clean up.
10:40pm	Ida sneaks out of her room for the beach. On the deck near the beach between the kitchen and the staff quarters, Irfan shoves Ida down steps, attempting to abort her 'baby'. <u>Ida slashed his vocal chords and lungs first so that he does not scream.</u> Ida kills Irfan.
11:00pm	Gilang closes the kitchen up and heads to his quarters. He sees Irfan's body on the way and removes Ida's nail from the crime scene.
24 June, 12:00am	Ani finishes work at the front office and heads to her quarters. She finds Irfan's body and screams.

The Resort's Layout

Maratua Paradise Resort is comprised of multiple wooden villas and huts standing over the sea, connected to each other by **open decks and walkways**. Guests arrive using a fishing boat at a long **pier** that leads to the **front desk hut**. Branching left, right, and backwards are empty **decks** with rope railings where guests can enjoy the view of the ocean or gather for events. There are potted tropical plants and flower to add to the scenery. From the deck, there is also a **netted area** in the sea where guests can kayak or swim.

Behind the front desk is the **dining hut** that's large enough to accommodate all guests from 8 villas at once. These **villas** line the left and right of the resort, allowing for the best views. Behind the dining hut are structures close to the beach. This includes the **kitchen** that's directly behind the dining hut, the small, co-joined **staff quarters** to the kitchen's left, and the **storage villa** to the right. Being the general manager of the resort, **Ari's villa** is the guest villa in front of the staff quarters.

The **beach** is connected to the resort via a deck and a small flight of stairs between the staff quarters and the kitchen. This is where Irfan was killed. The beach is small and hosts the Archery activity. The path towards the island is blocked by a rocky barricade that leads up a hill. Though this area has guided treks, guests do not venture far out and the trek is not recommended during stormy weather.

The Resort's Resources

To succeed, the Agents will need to make the most of what they can gather. This is what they can find by searching the resort or asking staff members.

Front desk: 1 first aid kit, earpieces and radios for staff to communicate among each other

Kitchen: kitchen knives

Storage: 2 kayaks (2 people each), 4 oars, SCUBA equipment, 4 bows, 40 arrows, 2 spears

Gabriel's fishing boat: 1 spear gun, 1 fishing net, 20m rope, 1 flare gun (5 flares)

Everyone's a Suspect

Agents will need to question people in order to gain more information. Keep in mind that everyone else at the hotel will react as a regular citizen would, and may also accuse the Agents and their companions themselves of the murder, question their authority, and the like. The Agents will need to contain the crime scene, calm people down, and keep Unnatural aspects hidden from everyone else while also protecting the innocents.

Only a few resort staff have remained at the resort. Due to word of a storm approaching, most staff have returned home on the fifth day before Devin's disappearance. Key staff members remained to manage the last batch of guests before temporarily closing the resort until the storm passes over. Of course, no one knew the storm would've been this severe or would've lasted this long.

Alibis are what each person would willingly share to the Agents. All other information would need to be asked from them, but that does not mean the person would answer with the truth (or answer at all).

All **resort staff** will say that Ari one day introduced Ida as his wife who agreed to be his assistant. They will note the strangeness of her being pregnant for over 9 months. If asked about Gilang's scars, no one but Gilang and Ari knows how he got them, but they know Gilang got his scars about a year ago.

Yanti, Mother

Yanti, a Chinese-Indonesian woman from Jakarta, is distraught and inconsolable. She doesn't know what took her son and husband, but puts the blame on herself. All she wants to do is go home. She will remain in her room, with Ida visiting her and bringing her food. Ida will attempt to comfort Yanti at any time. It won't end well. Ida will say that Irfan was not a good person anyway, which will send Yanti into a fit of rage.

Alibi: "I... I don't know what happened. I don't know anything. My husband, Irfan, he said... he was going to look for Devin one last time at night again. And then... I should've gone with him. We never should've come here."

Yanti will not speak much and doesn't want to. However, she will answer any questions to the best she could. Devin disappeared at night. Devin still wanted to run around, but Yanti was too tired. So, Irfan looked over Devin as Yanti went to bed early. Later, Irfan bursts into the room, saying Devin ran off into the beach and he lost sight of him because of the lack of lights. Because he felt immensely guilty and couldn't sleep, Irfan wanted to search the beach again before sleeping. Then, his body was found.

Ari, General Manager

Ari is a Chinese-Indonesian from Bandung. He has a very pleasant demeanour and appearance, as expected from his job. He tries to keep everyone as calm as possible, saying he will find a way to contact the local authorities and to reestablish communication. In a subtle and 'polite' way, Ari will question the authority of the Agents and will interfere with their investigation if it involves Ida. He's fluent in English, Indonesian, and Javanese (**ENG, IDN, JAVA 50%**).

Alibi: "I went to my room with Ida at 10pm, like I always do. Ida is my wife and works with me. Ani was still at the office then. I was asleep until, well Ani... then I got dressed as quickly as possible and came here."

If questioned about Ida, Ari says that he met her some time ago back home in Bandung and decided to hire her. Staff at this resort do not get to return home often, so the two can keep close this way. Obviously, this is a lie, but he hides it very well (**PERSUADE 80%**). He's very sure that the local authorities would eventually come and that he'll be able to put the nail back into Ida's throat. He also wants the best of two worlds: keeping Ida as his wife, and having this mess taken out of his hands by the police.

Even if the Agents confront him about Ida's truth, he'll insist that he never knew. If the Agents call his bluff, he'll deflect, asking what's wrong about loving someone else. If Ida dies, Ari will not grieve as much as normally expected, using the excuse of remaining professional.

If asked about other staff members, he's aware Bagas and Ani have been arguing, but he doesn't know why. Ida snuck out after Ari fell asleep and she returned before he awoke, so he's not aware of her leaving her room.

Searching Ari's bathroom can reveal Ida's wet, hand-washed laundry.

Gilang, Gardener

Gilang is a Flores man in his 40s. His moustache, his kind eyes, and his constant smile makes up for the heavy scars across his dark skin. As someone of lower income, he's immensely proud that he's able to send his daughter to Jogja for university. A dedicated man, he will continue to tend to the plants and clean the resort with his brimmed hat.

Gilang was told to hide the truth about Ida and does it out of fear of both Ida and losing the most profitable job he has had so far. Regardless, with his even tone and placid smile, he is very good at lying. It'll be hard to get the truth out of him (he has **PERSUADE 60%**), but it's possible. He speaks broken English (**ENG 30%**), but he's a native Indonesian and Riung speaker (**IDN and RIUNG 50%**).

Alibi: "I only work on the decks when the sun is out, to take care of the plants and to clean the decks. So the sun can dry them out. At night, I help clean the kitchen and dining area when all

the guests are gone. The time depends on when guests leave, but last night it was around 10pm. An early night. And then, I went to my room to sleep."

This is true, but not the whole truth. Gilang needed to pass the crime scene to return to his quarters. Gabriel and Bagas were arguing fiercely in the kitchen when Gilang came to clean up. The two stormed off early, leaving Bagas to close up by himself. Gilang thinks the two returned to their rooms. As a result, while he did arrive around 10pm, he finished around 11pm. This was how he found the body before anyone else. He's not certain of hearing any sounds due to being busy in the kitchen.

Gilang immediately knew it was Ida who killed Irfan because of the macabre crime scene and the nail that was in her neck. He kept the nail and immediately went to Ari's room to inform him. Ari tells Gilang it'll be fine, despite Gilang's insistence. Ari took the nail from Gilang and tells him to not tell anyone. If Ari is killed, Gilang will attempt to subdue Ida with a nail, and fail.

Bagas, Housekeeper

An opportunistic young man from Derawan, Bagas came from poverty and lucked himself into this job. He stole Irfan's rock while everyone was looking for Devin. Now that Irfan is dead, Bagas' paranoia of being caught stealing Irfan's rock makes him very defensive and short-sighted in making himself look guilty. He will quickly toss blame onto anyone, including the Agents, wanting nothing more but to get off the island quickly.

Bagas speaks broken English (**ENG 30%**), but is a native Indonesian and Bajau speaker (**IDN and BAJAU 50%**).

Alibi: "It's not me! I swear! I was already in my room since 10 o'clock and I didn't go out at all! You can ask Gilang. He saw me go back to my room. You know what? Ask Gabriel! He yelled at me like crazy in the kitchen and followed me to my room! Maybe he's the one who killed Irfan!"

Bagas does not know of the Unnatural or of hypergeometry. He has no idea what the rock in the suitcase is. But it looks shiny and rare, so he intends to sell it and bounce to another job, like what he has done before. He will only reveal that he stole a 'stupid rock' from Yanti's room when outright threatened. But that doesn't mean he killed him!

Searching Bagas' quarters can reveal Irfan's rock, hidden in a stack of folded clothes.

Gabriel, Chef and Fisherman

A rugged village man-of-action in his 30s, Gabriel's sparse words are always crass. He would much rather not be interacting with people and prefers busying himself with cooking or fishing at sea. This is what he will continue to do (or attempt to do). Gabriel doesn't underestimate the force of nature, but can challenge it if persuaded enough. He speaks broken English (**ENG 30%**), but is a native Indonesian and Bajau speaker (**IDN and BAJAU 50%**).

Alibi: "I was in the kitchen. Then I went to bed. Let me tell you this so you'll finish this fast: this is Bagas' fault. He brought bad luck here."

Ani told Gabriel that Bagas stole something from a guest, hoping he'll talk some sense into Bagas. Gabriel doesn't know what Bagas stole or who it specifically belonged to. His superstitions (**OCCULT 20%**) made him believe that this theft, and the item being stolen, was what caused the storm and

eventually Irfan's death. He won't elaborate on this, but adamantly believes it's true. He will tell the Agents that Ani told him to confront Bagas about it. He believes the stolen item should be thrown to sea, so the sea may accept it and stop the storm.

As a fisherman, Gabriel has **PILOT (Small Boat) 60%** to steer his fishing boat to either chauffer hotel guests from the mainland, send divers or snorkelers to their spots, or to fish. He has **ATHLETICS 40%** and has Special Training in using a **Bow** and a **Speargun** (may also branch off FIREARMS), **NAVIGATE 70%**, **SWIM 50%**, and **SURVIVAL 40%**.

Ani, Front Desk

Ani, a recent Hospitality graduate from Jakarta, is the busiest employee at the resort. She had volunteered to stay behind at the resort as other staff went home to avoid the storm. She is constantly working, whether it's tending to the guests, running through administrative work, being the middleman between the remaining staff, picking up on Ari's work, or trying to reestablish communication/transportation amidst the storm.

The storm, the murder, and the threat has made Ani anxious. Being all over the place made her sleep-deprived, too. She tries to hide it by working and by maintaining her composure in front of guests. She speaks fluent English and Indonesian (**ENG, IND 50%**) and some Mandarin Chinese (**CHI 35%**).

Alibi: "Well, I was working -- I was finishing writing today's logs in my agenda. The wifi also wasn't working so I tried fixing that, but it's still broken. I figured to try again tomorrow -- well, today. So I went from the front desk to my quarters at the back, near the beach, and then... and then I found Irfan's body."

Ani caught Bagas with a crystalline rock and questioned him about it, knowing it's not his. Bagas quickly ran away before Ani could chastise him. Not wanting to further stress Irfan and Yanti or to worry the other guests, Ani will not tell anyone about Bagas' theft without a successful **PERSUADE** roll, believing she can handle it swiftly. She does this by asking Gabriel to confront him due to her workload and Gabriel's reliability to get things done. She can describe the rock but doesn't know who Bagas stole from.

Ida, Assistant

Ida, a kuntilanak, hides her intelligence with her demure silence. Her minimal answers range from emoting with her face to simple one-word answers. Ari will often speak on her behalf, and he will defend her by saying she was with him. When asked whether what Ari says is true, she will simply smile. This is how she was in her bound state, and she intends on retaining this façade. Additionally, she always wears a black ribbon choker around her neck and will say it was a gift from Ari. This is what covers the nail (now hole) in her neck.

Unbound, Ida fully unlocks her capabilities as a vengeful spirit. She does her killings under the permanent full moon where she's at her most powerful state to seek revenge, whatever that may mean for her. She's able to switch between her pregnant woman form and her kuntilanak form. Ida will attempt to kill at least one person each night and will successfully do so without interference. **HUMINT** checks automatically fail on her.

People she will prioritise killing: Ari, Gilang, Kuro, Lucas, Bagas, Nelly

Encountering Ida the Kuntilanak

 *Mind Palace - Spiritfarer [Farewell Edition]*

In Ida's kuntilanak form, her stomach deflates and she turns ghostly pale, vacant black holes replacing her eyes. Though she can transform anytime while unbound, Ida only takes on her Kuntilanak form at night under a full moon, when she's at her strongest. If Ida is distance from the Agents, the Agents will be able to hear an infant crying. The closer they get to Ida, the quieter the sounds become, until the crying falls silent. She also smells of kamboja.

The Agents can talk to Ida, whether in her human or kuntilanak form. Unbound and free to speak, Ida willingly reveals that she suspected an otherworldly presence at the beach on the night Devin disappeared -- not human, but not like her, either. She saw Irfan at the beach, offering Devin's still body to a ghost-skinned, elongated humanoid adorned in jewellery that sparkled in the moonlight. The humanoid took Devin, touched the ground, and vanished. Learning this costs **SAN 0/1** Helplessness.

Even in her bound and weakened state, the deed was horrible enough to awaken her hunger for vengeance. Knowing Irfan was a bad person, Ida walked to the beach the next night to confront him. On the way, Irfan shoved her down a small flight of stairs that led to the beach. This is when Ida attacked and killed him, with Irfan removing her nail and unbinding her in the process.

Though Ida can be talked to rationally, she will always find reason to kill. If asked to help the Agents, her bloodlust will make her turn against them. Killing her results in +1D4 SAN.

 *Disrupted Original - Half-Life 2 Episode 1*

Ida, Kuntilanak

STR 20 CON 13 DEX 11 INT 13 CHA 12 POW 13
HP 13 WP 13 SAN n/a

ARMOUR: 0

SKILLS: Stream of Consciousness 80% (see **STREAM OF CONSCIOUSNESS**)

ATTACKS: Drain 50%, damage 2D10 CON (see **DRAIN**)

Eviscerate 50%, damage 1D4

Dodge 25%

BIND: Subduing Ida's Kuntilanak form is possible through driving a nail into her neck. This immediately makes her docile and reverts her back to her pregnant woman form. Her stats remain the same. She will not fight back anything that attacks her. When reduced to 0 HP, Ida can be permanently killed by driving a nail into the top of her head. Otherwise, her body will regenerate after 1D4 hours.

DRAIN: Ida grapples her target and sinks her fangs into the top of their head, sucking her target's innards out of their head. On subsequent rounds, Ida drains 2D10 CON per round. The target dies if reduced to zero CON. This CON loss is a permanent injury and the accompanying **SAN** loss (0/1D6 violence). Additionally, witnessing this or being a target to this costs **SAN 1/1D8** Unnatural once.

INHUMAN STATS: A test of a stat with a score of 20 or higher is a critical success on any roll up to the stat's score, and on any roll of matching digits except 100, which fumbles.

SAN LOSS: 0/1D4

Into Stormy Depths

The Agents may follow the rock's mystery after speaking to Gabriel and obtaining it from Bagas. If they choose to pursue it without resolving the murder mystery, Ida will kill her remaining targets. If some Agents are left behind, she may attempt to kill the Agents instead.

The resort will have enough SCUBA gear for all Agents. For this operation, **SWIM** is sufficient enough for using SCUBA gear, but having **SCUBA (swim)** grants **+20%** to **SWIM** checks while using SCUBA gear. It's impossible to steer a boat in this storm. However, Nyi Roro Kidul can sense the rock's presence and will calm a path through the waters that leads to above her domain (**SAN 0/1**). As long the boat stays on this path, the Agents will be able to travel safely.

The Stolen Rock

Irfan's rock is actually one half of a sea-shoggoth-weapon. This half functions like Thing in the Stone Face, but only underwater. The other half acts similarly: instead of expanding flesh and muscle, it absorbs matter. Combined, the whole orb creates a feedback loop where the absorbed matter creates flesh, which then gets absorbed in turn.

-- For Vikal's/Lily's eyes only

The crystalline rock before you looks nearly identical to the one that you have seen in the laboratories of Anggrek Bulan Nusantara. The only difference is its shape, but its observed properties are otherwise the same.

You know that Bulan's rock was fished out by a local fisherman on a Javan coast and was taken into Bulan's possession for its suspected hypergeometrical properties. Just like this rock, Bulan's rock has a curved edge that would sit nicely in your hand. Bulan had detected unidentified matter inside, mixed along with a thick, pale-blue substance and water. With all these particles swirling inside, it looks almost like a broken snow globe that didn't spill.

Now that you think about it, the stone you see before you now looks like the perfect half of Bulan's rock.

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This is how Nyi Roro Kidul created her domain, and this is how she controls and expands it. Ever since losing her orb, her domain remains compliant in following her around but is on the verge of collapsing into itself due to its mutation. Having Irfan's half would at least allow her to create a new domain or rebuild her current one.

Her Watery Domain

 *Dirac Shore - Half-Life 2*

When the Agents first arrive in the domain, Nyi Roro Kidul makes it inert to allow them to pass through. It is very dark, but the SCUBA gear's torch is strong enough to navigate through them.

Despite the oversea current being extremely strong (besides the path), the undersea current remains calm. Regardless, heighten the sense of claustrophobia, the pressure and darkness crushing them as they venture deeper, and the cold cutting through their suits.

From outside, the domain is marked by an underwater waterfall of sand. This is all that's visible of it as well. The Agents can enter the domain from above water by directly going into the underwater waterfall, or by swimming into it. Once inside, the domain breaks the rule of space. A bony network of pale stone and dead coral form the spiraling tunnels of an underwater labyrinth, which crawls through the water and down into the darkness as far as the eye can see (**SAN** 0/1 Unnatural).

Whoever holds the rock must willingly lose **SAN** 1D4 to know the way to Nyi Roro Kidul. What this looks like to others is that the leading Agent swims straight and downwards, while the tunnels are the ones that twist in their favour.

As the Agents go deeper, they can spot skeletons of various sea creatures: fish, sea turtles, cuttlefish, dolphins, and others. There are also clusters whole and decaying sea creature corpses, like dead sea creatures lying in overfished nets. Nothing visible feeds on these corpses. No check is needed to see that some of the skeletons are very obviously older than others.

One identifiable corpse is that of a dolphin. **MARINE BIOLOGY** or another relevant **SCIENCE** can identify it as an endangered Indian Ocean humpback dolphin. These dolphins are restricted to the Indian Ocean. Someone can use **MARINE BIOLOGY**, another relevant **SCIENCE**, or **INT** to recall that the Agents are currently in the Pacific Ocean.

It will be very wise of Agents to remember which paths they have taken. As the tunnels span and intertwine infinitely, the stone showed them the only path to the throne room; they simply must take the same path back, as it guarantees them to surface.

Nyi Roro Kidul

Negative Pressure - Half:Life 2

At the end of the labyrinth is a long, deep, and dark drop. Agents can feel the cold intensify as they swim towards Nyi Roro Kidul's throne room that sits at the bottom of her domain. The throne room is a large cavern devoid of an audience. In place of decorations are lumps of masses similar to the ones in the tunnels. Except now, they almost shiver in place, emitting something that the Agents know *isn't* green light but allows them to see the throne room perfectly without light. No curved wall is devoid of these lumps. Long strands of seaweed adorn where Nyi Roro Kidul sits.

Nyi Roro Kidul the beautiful Queen of the Southern Sea (as in the southern coast of Java, which is the Indian Ocean). Her dark, thick hair flows in hypnotising curves. The batik motifs on her sarong ebb and shift like the patterns and colours on a wary cuttlefish, and her golden jewelry adorning her head, arms, and her green kemben dazzle despite the lack of light. The queen also has a sea-foam green cloak and a golden sceptre (with its centrepiece missing) for commanding her power. She looks like a young Javanese or Sundanese woman, but occasionally, her skin may flare like the scales of a reptile. She may also trade her legs for a green mermaid tail whenever she likes.

Agents will need to make a **POW** check to resist her charm (-20% if the Agent is wearing green, which she has an affinity for) -- she does not care enough for the Agents to do anything with them (including fighting them), but she enjoys collecting souls. On failure, the Agent will be tranced and

will want to stay with Nyi Roro Kidul. A periodic **POW** check can break the Agent out of this trance. Attacking Nyi Roro Kidul does nothing, and she will only laugh at the attempt.

Nyi Roro Kidul, with a smile, will cut to the chase and ask for the stone. However, she only speaks **JAVANESE** and **SUNDANESE**. Despite the language barrier, the Agents will probably know to hand it to her. Once the players do, she will simply leave to return to her home, the Indian Ocean. Her domain will follow her. This is bad for the Agents. Very bad.

Escape

To the Agents, the domain begins to collapse, bulge, and swallow them. The wall's shivering intensifies and begin to sag and heave to follow Nyi Roro Kidul, leaving ghostly preimages of its movements. Tranced Agents may make one last **POW** check to avoid being consumed by the domain.

The Agents will need to make a number of checks to escape. **SWIM** determines if they are deft enough to navigate the shifting tunnels. Failure means that Agent's oxygen tank gets broken, and they'll need to make a **CON** check to determine if they drown (unless an Agent has **SCUBA** and is aware that SCUBA gear generally come with two mouthpieces for emergencies to share air). Failure brings them to 0 HP and they'll need to be resuscitated immediately to avoid death.

NAVIGATE determines if the Agent remembers the route back to the surface (the path Nyi Roro Kidul created stays the same, as she has no reason to trap the Agents and prioritises returning home). Any amount of Agents can choose to roll. If half or more succeed, the Agents are able to stay together and avoid conflicting directions to escape in time. If less than half succeed, all Agents must reroll **SWIM** to see if they can make up for time with speed. If all Agents fail, they will all perish.

Mulyani will round the rear. She will always end up successfully sacrificing herself for the Agents' survival. If she succeeds her **SWIM** check, she sacrifices her life for someone who failed the second **SWIM** check by grabbing and pushing them upwards as she swims, or the first **SWIM** check if no second swim check is made. Mulyani defaults to saving Kiara if she fails either. If she fails, Kiara rescues her, but Mulyani ends up releasing herself so Kiara can swim herself to safety.

🎵 *A Gentle Docking - Half-Life: Alyx*

You are less than a metre away from breaking out of the water. The sound of squelching and crumbling follows behind you, but the hope ignited by the pull of the sun's warmth is stronger than your fear.

BANG. A sharp crack makes you look back -- a humbling reminder from the forces that be that you that you are not safe yet. The domain is sealing itself now with bony growths, and the strength of the current it creates reels you in. You kick harder, swim harder, your throat burning and parched as you draw rapid breaths into your cold lungs, desperately feeding them with life to propel yourself forward. You realise that it hurts, that oxygen stings your sandpaper throat.

How can something so vital sting you so much? How can something so important hurt you so much?

Cold pressurised air shoots through your skull as you look down. The domain's coral teeth ram into Johanna Mulyani. A muffled yell. The creak of bone. She pushes herself away and swims

towards you, but the domain is relentless, building itself higher and higher like a diseased tumour, the animated scaffold of a building lurching towards her legs, closing in onto her chest.

Another scream: Kiara. A violent stream of bubbles erupt and she dives, hands cutting through water as she dolphin-kicks into the closing maul of the domain's entrance. Kiara lunges forward. Her fingertips reach forward.

There is a brief second of ringing pressure in your ears as molecules compress together.

You see the water in front of Kiara's hands pull apart and erupt. The domain's entrance explodes. Kinetic energy ripples through your body. Kiara recoils, and in that moment, Mulyani is free. Blood trailing her side, she pushes through water and swims towards the light. Mulyani reaches for Kiara, and Kiara reaches for Mulyani.

The swirling current reaches Mulyani first and sucks her into the dark. Her blood trail swirls in the water like the smoke of an extinguished candle.

The domain retreats. The boat's steps bob overhead. All you see is vast, deep blue.

Whether the Agents accept Mulyani's death or interpret it as a disappearance is their choice. Regardless, watching Mulyani die costs **SAN 1/1D8** Helplessness. Learning of it later costs **SAN 1/1D6** Helplessness. Upon witnessing Mulyani's 'death', Kiara will also unleash what has been embedded in her with a strong surge of emotion. This costs 3 WP and **SAN 1D4**.

Resolution

When the last of Nyi Roro Kidul's domain dissipates, the water calms and the storm clears. The moon returns to normal. Communications are restored and the local authorities will be alerted to the body/bodies at the resort. The Agents will now altogether need to cover up what really happened and agree on an alibi when questioned by the police.

Ida's body, if killed, must be hidden. If Gilang is still alive, he will suggest and help with moving Ida's body to the mountains as both a way of hiding it, and to perhaps catch a wild animal that can be put to blame. If Gabriel is still alive, he is willing to help drop the body in the middle of the ocean. Yanti will also ask questions about her husband and son. She'd be willing to accept anything that gives her closure.

If either Ari or Ani are alive, they will report Anggrek Bulan Nusantara's part in investigating the corpse(s), moving it to the villa with them, and asking around. The police will want to know what the Agents gleaned. Being caught lying may raise the police's suspicions.

Kiara will be withdrawn, silently packing Mulyani's and her belongings and arranging new plane tickets back to Jakarta.